

Skype 5

The popular voice-video conferencing tool
Skype has gone into version 5 beta 1

Peppermint Linux

Web-apps based Linux distribution
Peppermint Linux released

Cellphone test

media replacing the Browser screen. The display looks beautiful in landscape mode, will all the icons sprawled to completely fill the screen.

The camera is the main feature of the phone, and one has to say that the image quality is excellent, racking up next to the Xperia X10 and the Vivaz, with their similar 8.1-megapixel cameras, though the flash is not too bright. However, all that 'intelligence' described earlier doesn't do too much visibly, nor the multiple face detection. The video recording quality is also excellent, with near no blurring even with quick pans.

The audio playback quality is good as well, offering Dolby Mobile sound when earphones are connected. The loud-speaker, located in the earpiece again like the Chocolate, is powerful, but lacking bass.

Verdict:

The phone didn't perform very well under call clarity tests, with the earpiece working well enough, but the bundled earphones were not too good, and the loudspeaker, while loud, was not very clear. This problem is fixable though, as even though the headphone jack is proprietary, any 3.5mm headphone can be connected to the handsfree. Overall, the Vivaz's superior build quality, battery life, and 3G speeds put it ahead of the Viewty Smart.

Samsung B7610 OmniaPro and I8000 Omnia II

There is not much difference between the Samsung B7610 OmniaPro and I8000 Omnia II. They are basically the same phone, with almost all the same specifications, from the Windows Mobile 6.1 Professional, the Samsung S3C6410 800MHz

processor, to 256MB RAM, and a 5-megapixel camera.

The differences, or the places where the OmniaPro lags behind the Omnia II, are: HSDPA rating of 7.2Mbps versus 3.6Mbps, HSUPA network, 3.7-inch AMOLED screen versus 3.5-inch, proximity sensor, WMV support, WMDRM and OMA DRM support, no Flash support, and greater weight.

Where the Omnia II lags behind the OmniaPro is a full QWERTY keyboard, 3GP support, WAV support, shorter



Samsung I8000 Omnia

standby battery life, and no choice of Work and Life user modes.

The first thing you notice about the phones are their stunning AMOLED display, and their brightness, vividness and clarity will take your breath away, even with the 65K effective colour limitation due to the dated operating system. With their 800 MHz processor and dedicated graphics accelerator, the phones do not lack in performance, with breezy multitasking. The phone can be upgraded to run on Win-

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